

CareerMap

Your personalised career report

Story-driven explorer of human nature

Class 11 · Decision Window

PROFILE TYPE	TOP DOMAINS	GRADE STAGE
Decision Window	Human-centered Research and Storytelling Building and Scaling Ideas from the Ground Up Data-driven Social Change and Policy	Class 11

3 careers · Personalised · 2025

ABOUT THIS REPORT

What is inside

You are in Class 11 or 12. Stream choices, subject selections and your first internship all happen in the next 12 to 18 months. This report is designed to help you make those choices deliberately, not by default.

Free counsellor call included

After you read this report a counsellor will call you within 48 hours. The call is to help you understand what is in here and decide on your next steps. It is not a sales call.

■ Your thinking style

How you process information and where you do your best work

■ Your strengths and blind spots

Drawn directly from your answers, not a generic template

■ Three career deep-dives

Each career covered fully: fit, paths, stream guidance, degrees, salary, internships and your first 30 days

■ Parent summary

So they understand your direction without you having to explain everything

SECTION 1 — YOUR THINKING STYLE

How You Think

You are drawn to understanding why people think and behave the way they do, and you want real skill at something specific — not a vague sense of direction. You go deep on topics that matter to you rather than spreading thin across many things.

When you worked through the reasoning questions, you traced the argument step by step rather than going with instinct. That combination of curiosity, structure and empathy is exactly what research, journalism and systems-level work rewards.

SECTION 2 — STRENGTHS AND BLIND SPOTS

What your answers showed

Your strengths

■ Goes deep on what interests you

You follow a topic for hours without noticing time passing. That focus is rare and it is the starting point for doing anything well.

■ Strong logical reasoning

You worked through the reasoning questions carefully and got them right. You think in structured steps, which shows up whenever you need to make a case or solve a problem.

■ Stays the course through difficulty

You admire people who handle failure and keep going, and you do the same. You feel it, then figure out what to do differently. That is how good work gets built.

■ Listens before speaking

You hear all sides before you say anything. In careers that depend on understanding people, that is a genuine professional skill.

■ Honest about what you want

Freedom and real skill both matter to you. You are not performing idealism. That honesty will help you make better decisions.

Areas to watch

■ Waiting until it feels right

You let things sit before you start. That instinct can serve you in slow, careful work — but in fast-moving fields like journalism or startups, it will cost you opportunities.

■ Narrow social investment

You go deep with one or two people rather than wide. In research and media, the person you know loosely is often the one who opens the door.

■ Distraction under pressure

When you feel pressure, you get distracted and try to refocus rather than push through. Understanding what specifically breaks your concentration will help you manage it.

CAREER 1 OF 3 — HUMAN-CENTERED RESEARCH AND STORYTELLING

Human-centered Research and Storytelling

Why this fits you

Your curiosity about why people behave the way they do, combined with how you read and create across multiple forms, points clearly toward careers where you investigate human behaviour and then communicate what you found. You are already doing the foundational work — going deep on things that matter, listening carefully, noticing what others miss. The question is which format you want to do it in.

Paths within this domain

› Journalist or reporter

You pick a beat — politics, health, business, crime — and cover it every week. Most of the job is getting people to talk honestly. The writing is the last part.

› Long-form or features writer

You spend weeks on a single story, read everything written about the subject, talk to everyone involved, and write a piece that gives the full picture.

› UX researcher

You talk to real users of a product, find the problem the design team has not spotted yet, and make the case for fixing it clearly enough that they act on it.

› Documentary filmmaker

You spend months researching and building access before you turn on a camera. The footage is the last thing you gather, not the first.

› Psychology researcher

You spend months designing a study, run it with real people, and then work out what the results actually mean. One careful study can take two years.

› Social anthropologist

You spend enough time inside a community that people stop acting differently around you. That is when the real observations become possible.

Stream and subject guidance

A humanities stream is the most direct path — English, History, Political Science and Psychology are all relevant. A science stream does not close this off. Psychology and sociology programmes at many universities accept students from any stream. If you are still choosing subjects, keeping a language and a social science alongside your core subjects will help.

Undergraduate degrees to consider

› Bachelor of Arts in Journalism and Mass Communication

The most direct route into print, digital and broadcast journalism. Covers reporting, editing, media law and production.

› Bachelor of Mass Media (BMM)

Broader than journalism — covers advertising, PR and digital media alongside reporting. Useful if you want flexibility across media roles.

› Bachelor of Arts in English or Humanities

Builds the reading, writing and critical thinking that underpin all storytelling work. Strong for long-form writing, content strategy and editorial careers.

› **Bachelor of Arts or Science in Psychology**

The entry point for research-based careers and UX research roles. Opens postgraduate paths in clinical, organisational and cognitive psychology.

› **Bachelor of Arts in Sociology**

Useful for documentary work, social journalism and policy research. Builds understanding of how communities and systems work.

› **Bachelor of Design in Communication Design**

For students who want to combine storytelling with visual work — editorial design, infographics, interactive media.

Guidance reflects general pathways across boards. Your counsellor will personalise this for your specific board, location and current subjects on the call.

Market demand and salary

DEMAND



ENTRY	MID-CAREER	TOP EARNERS
3–6 LPA	8–16 LPA	25 LPA+

Salary ranges are illustrative and reflect broad market patterns for India as of 2023–24. Actual compensation varies significantly by employer, city, specialisation, and individual performance. Source: NASSCOM, Glassdoor India, ASSOCHAM industry reports.

Internships to target in the next 12 months

Journalism intern	Online publications, newsletters, local news platforms
Research assistant	University departments, think tanks, policy organisations
Video research volunteer	Independent filmmakers, YouTube journalists
UX research volunteer	Early-stage startups that need user feedback

Find these on Internshala, LinkedIn and Unstop. For research and project roles, a direct email works better than a portal application.

Your next 30 days

Read one long-form journalism or research piece this week. Write 200 words on how the writer investigated their subject — not just what they found, but how they went about finding it. Then find one person working in this space and send them one specific question by email.

● Have questions about this career section? [WhatsApp us](#)

CAREER 2 OF 3 — BUILDING AND SCALING IDEAS FROM THE GROUND UP

Building and Scaling Ideas from the Ground Up

Why this fits you

You value freedom and want to be genuinely skilled at something. You admire people who handle failure and keep going — and you do the same. That combination shows up in people who do well in early-stage startups and product roles, not because they never struggle, but because they stay committed to a problem through the difficult early stages when most people step back.

Paths within this domain

› Startup founder

You make ten decisions before lunch, most without enough information, and you live with what happens next. The work never looks the same two weeks in a row.

› Product manager

You sit between the engineers, the designers and the business side and decide what gets built first. Every decision involves trade-offs with no clean answer.

› Business analyst

Organisations bring you in when they do not know what is wrong. You figure it out and say it plainly, usually to people who did not want to hear it.

› Growth strategist

You find the one thing that will move the number that matters and focus on it harder than everyone else in the room.

› Early-stage operator

You handle everything the founder should not be spending time on so they can focus on what only they can do.

› Innovation consultant

You help large organisations move faster. Most of the job is working with the people inside who resist the change.

Stream and subject guidance

This path works with any stream at undergraduate level. Strong people in startups and product come from engineering, commerce, economics and humanities equally. What matters more than stream is whether you actively seek out real problems to solve during your undergraduate years. Commerce and economics give you a head start on business fundamentals but are not a requirement.

Undergraduate degrees to consider

› Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA)

The most direct undergraduate route into business and startup roles. Covers management, finance, marketing and strategy.

› Bachelor of Arts in Economics

Strong analytical foundation. Useful for strategy, consulting and policy roles as well as startup and product paths.

› Bachelor of Technology (any branch)

Opens the widest range of startup and product roles. Engineering background is not required but gives you credibility in tech environments.

› Bachelor of Science in Statistics or Data Science

Increasingly useful for growth, product analytics and business analysis roles across any industry.

› Integrated Programme in Management (IPM)

A five-year BBA plus MBA offered at a small number of institutions. Strong preparation for consulting and general management careers.

› Bachelor of Commerce (BCom)

Solid foundation in accounting, finance and business. Often paired with CA or MBA preparation.

Guidance reflects general pathways across boards. Your counsellor will personalise this for your specific board, location and current subjects on the call.

Market demand and salary

DEMAND



Growing

ENTRY	MID-CAREER	TOP EARNERS
3–6 LPA	8–18 LPA	25 LPA+

Salary ranges are illustrative and reflect broad market patterns for India as of 2023–24. Actual compensation varies significantly by employer, city, specialisation, and individual performance. Source: NASSCOM, Glassdoor India, ASSOCHAM industry reports.

Internships to target in the next 12 months

Startup operations intern	Early-stage startups — search Internshala and LinkedIn
Founder's assistant	Solo founders who need an extra pair of hands
Growth or marketing intern	Consumer brands, SaaS companies, mobile apps
Business research intern	Consulting firms, market research companies

Find these on Internshala, LinkedIn and Unstop. For research and project roles, a direct email works better than a portal application.

Your next 30 days

Listen to one founder interview this week. Write down the specific failure they described and the one thing they changed because of it. Then find one early-stage startup and send a short email offering to help with anything they need. You do not need a resume to do this.

● Have questions about this career section? [WhatsApp us](#)

CAREER 3 OF 3 — DATA-DRIVEN SOCIAL CHANGE AND POLICY

Data-driven Social Change and Policy

Why this fits you

You are good with logic and structured reasoning, you care about understanding human behaviour, and you want work that has a real effect on how systems work. This domain puts all three together. It is smaller than the other two paths but it is growing, and the combination of analytical thinking and genuine curiosity about people is exactly what this work needs.

Paths within this domain

› Policy researcher or analyst

You write recommendations knowing they could change how a programme runs for thousands of people, or be filed away and never read. Both outcomes are possible.

› Data analyst for an NGO or think tank

You take messy information gathered from the field and turn it into something a decision-maker can actually use.

› Behavioural economist

You test whether changing how a choice is shown to people changes what they decide, then use that finding to design better systems.

› Civic technologist

You build tools that help governments or communities do things they currently do slowly, badly or not at all.

› Programme evaluator

You go into a social programme after it has run and find out honestly whether it worked and why.

› Research scientist in social science

You spend years on a question that most people do not even know needs asking yet.

Stream and subject guidance

Economics and Political Science are the most useful subjects for this path. Sociology and Statistics are also directly relevant. If you are in a science stream, Mathematics and Statistics give you a strong base for the data and research side of this work. Most postgraduate programmes in public policy and economics expect either an Economics background or a strong quantitative one — so the subjects you choose now shape your options later.

Undergraduate degrees to consider

› Bachelor of Arts in Economics

The most direct route into policy research and behavioural economics. Strong quantitative foundation and widely accepted for postgraduate programmes.

› Bachelor of Arts in Political Science or Public Administration

Useful for policy research, civic technology and government roles. Often combined with Economics or Sociology.

› Bachelor of Arts in Sociology

Strong foundation for programme evaluation, NGO research and social impact roles.

› Bachelor of Science in Statistics or Data Science

Opens the data analyst and quantitative research side of this domain. Increasingly sought by think tanks and policy organisations.

› Bachelor of Arts in Psychology

Entry point for behavioural economics and human-centred policy design. Useful alongside an economics or statistics minor.

› Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science

Opens civic technology and data-driven policy roles. Many civic tech organisations actively look for people with both technical and social science backgrounds.

Guidance reflects general pathways across boards. Your counsellor will personalise this for your specific board, location and current subjects on the call.

Market demand and salary

DEMAND



High and growing

ENTRY	MID-CAREER	TOP EARNERS
4–8 LPA	12–25 LPA	40 LPA+

Salary ranges are illustrative and reflect broad market patterns for India as of 2023–24. Actual compensation varies significantly by employer, city, specialisation, and individual performance. Source: NASSCOM, Glassdoor India, ASSOCHAM industry reports.

Internships to target in the next 12 months

Research volunteer	University research labs, public health organisations
NGO data and content intern	Social enterprises, impact organisations
Policy research intern	Think tanks, electoral trusts, civic organisations
Data analysis intern	Market research firms, analytics startups

Find these on Internshala, LinkedIn and Unstop. For research and project roles, a direct email works better than a portal application.

Your next 30 days

Search for one example of how a researcher used a small change in how a choice was shown to people to get a better outcome. Try searching behavioural nudge in education or health. Read the full case. Write three questions it raises for you. Those questions are your starting point.

● Have questions about this career section? [WhatsApp us](#)

PARENT SUMMARY

For parents to read

This page is written for you.

The rest of the report is written for your child. This page is for you.

Your child has strong analytical reasoning and genuine curiosity about why people think and behave the way they do.

The three domains in this report — research and storytelling, building ideas, and data-driven policy — all have financially solid careers attached to them.

One internship before Class 12 exams changes their application story significantly. That is worth helping them create time for in the next few months.

The counsellor call

A CareerMap counsellor will call within 48 hours to walk you through this report. They have read it in full. Bring your questions, your doubts, and anything that did not feel right.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Three things to do now

1**Read the career that pulled you most**

Not the most impressive one. The one where you felt something while reading it. Go back to that chapter and read the 30-day step at the end.

2**Do the 30-day step for that career**

It is one specific action. It takes less than an hour to start. Do not wait until you feel ready.

3**Take the counsellor call**

A counsellor will contact you within 48 hours. The call is about this report and your next steps. Bring one question.

CareerMap 2025 · Confidential, for the student named on the cover only. Guidance reflects general pathways across boards. Specific college options, entrance exams and cutoffs will be covered on your counsellor call.